Application for Vacant Board Seat in Zone 1

Personal Information

Jazzmin Reece
[redacted]
~12 years, **resident at current address**
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Question 1.
What motivated you to apply for a position on the school board? Please include any experiences you have had with the school district as a parent, student, educator, or community member, nonprofit or public board.

Portland Public Schools and the Oregon public education system is at a critical inflection point; and I would like to play a more formal role to help usher in systemic and meaningful change that serves all students. More specifically, the Oregon education system has failed to deliver “a sum of money sufficient to ensure that the state’s system of public education meets quality goals established by law” as outlined in the Oregon Constitution (Article VIII. Section 8. Adequate Equitable Funding). We know that all of our students in Oregon deserve a quality education; sufficient funding and that a measurable feedback loop of accountability is required to safeguard the taxpayer investments of this common good.

As a parent, school volunteer and tax payer, I have been actively engaged in the classroom, school building, and with matters of Portland Public School policy making. I currently serve as a room parent for my child’s teacher, and help to connect parents to the classroom and resources to aid the teacher with their classroom curriculum plan. I also serve as Treasurer of the executive board for Bridlemile PTA; where I help oversee the fundraising and fiscal accounting for our classroom supply grants to teachers, and major community programs to serve and support every student and their families. This past year I also served on the CPS for the Ida B. Wells Bond program. Over the past few years I have participated in Legislative lobby initiatives to fully fund public schools and have also testified to the Legislative joint ways and means committee on education to fully fund the QEM.

Question 2.
What is your understanding of the primary functions and responsibilities of a public school board?

The Portland Public School Board is tasked with the oversight of all the policies that govern the school district; and with the supervision of its head superintendent and associated educational support team. The School Board will continually review and amend its District policies by way of special committee and public disclosure process, and be responsible for the recruitment and retention of the superintendent.

Application for Vacant Board Seat in Zone 1

Question 3.
How would you prioritize issues such as academic achievement, equity, student mental health, and teacher support? Can you give an example of a time you took action or provided leadership to prioritize an issue of importance.

Given the current state of Portland Public Schools, and not knowing what I do not know, or am not privileged to have access to, I would prioritize issues with the following rank:

1. Equity
2. Academic Achievement (improvement)
3. Student mental health
4. Teacher support

While serving on the Wells CPC Bond project, the question of the public pool was raised several times by members of the public, and the project team had not provided a timely or sufficient response to the outstanding questions and concerns, given the total projected cost of the Bond project. Myself and several other members of the CPC leveraged our resources and acumen to partake in a due diligence project and community survey regarding the public's goals for the pool with respect to the IGA and contract from the 1950s. The findings were presented at the PPS facilities committee meeting as an exhibit separate from the CPC project team report.

Question 4.
How do you envision supporting students from diverse backgrounds and ensuring educational equity?

First, one must meet their consumer/audience/client where they are at, to understand how to best serve and deliver a product that is diverse, multilayered, complex and equitable.

This is not PPS or a special interest group dictating the level of service from a top down perspective; this is the recipient of a service sharing/telling and providing insight to how they want to be served, from a bottom up 360 review.

Yes, equity requires slowing down to speed up, and to forgo hegemony and rethink constructs of power and how power is wielded.

Application for Vacant Board Seat in Zone 1

Question 5.
What particular skills or expertise would you bring to the Board?

- Over 20 years of experience as a competitive athlete and youth coach
    - Willamette University
    - Clackamas Community College
    - Southridge High School
    - St. Mary's Academy
    - Foothills Soccer Club
    - Bridlemile Basketball
    - Albina Track Club
    - NPCE & SEI - Nike Product Creation Project with Self Enhancement Inc.
- Over 15 years of Management Consulting and Project Management experience
    - private real estate development and property management
    - public service work and IT projects
    - Corporate IT projects
- Over 15 years of experience in real estate development, land use and sales
    - Oregon licensed real estate broker
    - private real estate development and property management
    - public economic and real estate development
    - Metro Parks Bond Advisor
    - North Williams Avenue transportation safety committee
- Over 12 years of non-profit Board leadership experience
    - Urban League of Portland - Young Professionals
    - City Club of Portland - Board of Governors
- Over 3 years of PTA Board and committee leadership
    - Bridlemile Elementary School

Question 6.
How would you balance the needs of students, teachers, and the broader community when making decisions?

To balance the needs of students, teachers, and the broader community when making decisions; one must first understand the current state of any policy and then the impact of any proposed policy change. For district wide impact a comprehensive public engagement project should be considered. For a discrete and localized policy change, a smaller subset of stakeholders should be convened and impact of change evaluated. Additionally, we do not know what we do not know - so decision making should be a thoughtful exercise of gap analysis.

Question 7.
How do you think about the trade-offs in the school district's budgeting process?

All public tax payer budgets are fiscally constrained; for context, therefore tradeoffs are a fact of the budget process. Additionally, one must approach public budgets from a philosophical lens to "due no harm: or "harm reduction." The least harm theory by John Staturt Mills "On Liberty" best speaks to my belief in equity and governance in a budget process.

Application for Vacant Board Seat in Zone 1

Question 8.
What experience do you have advocating for a cause, issue, campaign, legislation, etc.?

As previously stated I am currently serve on the executive Board of the Bridemile PTA, and have actively lobbied and testified to the Legislature to fully fund public school education at the QEM. Additionally, I actively fundraise to financially support teachers, staff, students and families at Bridlemile Elementary School. In the past I have lobbied the State and Congress on behalf of the National Urban League and its local chapter in Portland to prioritize its policy platforms for jobs, civil rights and equal justice.

Question 9.
What does diversity, equity, and inclusion mean to you in the context of public education? What is your lived experience that defines this perspective?

I am Jazzmin Hanako Reece, and I am a living and breathing testament of diversity, equity and inclusion.

My family is both Japanese, Filipino, African-American, Native and we have walked many miles and lived a plight for equality, justice and equal and civil rights under the law. Within the timeline of my parents' lives, laws have been changed so that I may enjoy equal protections under the law, which include integrated schools and public services - free of segregation.

My family has suffered a loss of intergenerational wealth and its growth potential when my family was interned at the Minidoka Japanese internment camp; they lost their homes and small businesses.

I personally know the feeling of exclusion from childhood friendships, and experiences due to the color of my skin.

To feel it, is to know it, as Victor Hugo states in Les Miserables; which is why I take racial equity and justice personally. This is not a textbook or academic experience; for me, this is my life and how I see and engage in the world, and that cannot be usurped by a PhD. or social media campaign or research project.

Application for Vacant Board Seat in Zone 1

Question 10.
How would you work to address disparities in educational opportunities and outcomes for marginalized groups, including students of color, LGBTQ+ students, and students with disabilities?

The job of the School Board is to oversee PPS policy and to employ and oversee the Superintendent.

1. Support and partner with Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong and her mission to serve PPS students and the employees; and
2. Advocate and lobby for the full funding of Oregon public schools at the QEM; and
3. Listen to the constituents; and PPS Community on how service needs to evolve and innovate to meet students and the community where they are at and help elevate them in their pursuit for a high school diploma and future career opportunities.
4. Listen to the PPS employees and how/what they need to improve their work place environment and service delivery
5. Partner with Dr. Armstrong to develop an accountability roundtable with representatives from the community to raise, track and resolve issues to improve service delivery and outcomes for marginalized communities.